



WORD MINISTRY TRAINING

The Science & Craft of Ministering the Word

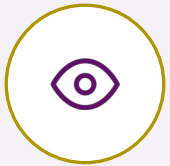
Preparing and delivering the word with clarity, flow, encouragement and impact.

2 Timothy 2:15

THE CRAFT

There is a science and a craft in ministering the word of God.

When people are listening to you, they want to hear —



Clarity

Words they can follow



Flow

Each idea connects



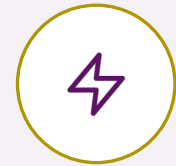
Understanding

Truth that opens up



Encouragement

Strength, not shame



Impact

The anointing at work





*Be diligent to present yourself approved to God,
a worker who does not need to be ashamed,
rightly dividing the word of truth.*

2 TIMOTHY 2:15 (NKJV)



01 — CLARITY

Make it easy to understand.

Easy, uncomplicated words. If you are confused while preparing the word, that is a strong indicator your listeners will be confused too.

You are competing for their attention

Every listener arrives already occupied. Clear words cut through what is competing for them.



Their own thoughts



Distractions



Demonic powers

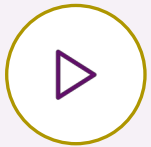


The preparation test

If it confuses you on the desk, it will confuse them in the pew. Sit with the point until you can say it in one plain sentence — then preach it.



One idea flows into the next.



Introduction

Open the subject and show why it matters today.



Body

Build the argument point by point, each one carrying the last.



Conclusion

Land it — what they must now believe, and do.



One verse supports what is being said, and the interpretation of that verse supports the next. Nothing stands alone.



03 — ENCOURAGEMENT

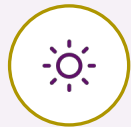
Don't leave people condemned.

Guilt is not your tool. Allow the Holy Spirit to convict — your work is to heal, comfort, challenge and charge.



Heal

Bind up what is broken



Comfort

Steady the weary



Challenge

Call them higher



Charge

Send them out to act

But the one who prophesies speaks to people for their strengthening, encouraging and comfort.

1 CORINTHIANS 14:3 (NIV)



We all have our biases.

Some of us lean on the Old Testament, some on the New. Know where you lean, and work to balance it.



Old Testament

Covenant, law, prophets and the long story of God with His people.



New Testament

Christ, the cross, grace and the life of the early church.

Preach the whole counsel of God.



The anointing you carry.

God will minister to His people through the unique way He has anointed you. Do not borrow another person's delivery — carry your own.



Some shout

Fire and volume that stir a room



Some are soft

A quiet voice that settles deep



Some joke

Humour that opens hearts

Same Spirit. Different vessels.

IN PRACTICE

How do you get the sermons for Sundays?

A sermon should have a purpose — and the purpose informs the content.



Start with purpose

Ask what God is saying to this house this Sunday, and what must change in the hearer.



Let purpose choose content

Text, illustrations and application are selected because they serve that purpose — not the other way round.



Rightly dividing the word of truth.

2 TIMOTHY 2:15 (NKJV)

